# MENTORQUE | RESUME BLUEPRINT

Sales • Account Executive • SDR / BDR • Sales Leadership

## PART 1 — GENERAL RESUME GUIDELINES

### 1.1 The Non-Negotiables

- One page — always. The only exception is 8+ years of directly relevant, non-repetitive experience. Two pages is a privilege, not a default.
- Font: Calibri, Arial, or Garamond. Size 10–11 pt for body; 13–14 pt for name. Never decorative, never Comic Sans.
- Margins: 0.5"–0.75" on all sides. Below 0.5" signals desperation; above 1" wastes space.
- Send as PDF every time — unless the employer explicitly asks for .docx. PDF locks formatting across all devices and OS.
- File name: FirstName_LastName_Role_Resume.pdf. Never 'CV_final_v4_USE THIS.pdf'.
- Zero photos, zero graphics, zero icons, zero borders — unless you are submitting a design portfolio where visual sense IS the work product.
- Never write 'References available upon request'. Every recruiter knows. It wastes a full line.
- No 'I', 'my', or 'we' anywhere. Every line starts with an action verb or a strong noun phrase.
- Consistent tense: current role in present tense, all previous roles in past tense. Mixing tenses signals carelessness.

### 1.2 Appearance & Alignment

- Every section heading must look identical — same font size, same weight, same color. Inconsistency implies you cut-and-pasted from multiple templates.
- Dates are always right-aligned on the same line as company or institution. Never on a separate line below.
- White space is a design tool — 4–6 pt spacing between bullets, 10–14 pt between sections. A dense page is unreadable at a 6-second glance.
- Bold only four things: company/institution names, your job titles, degree names, and critical technology names used as anchors in experience bullets. Bold is not emphasis — it is scannability.
- All bullet points at the same left indent — misalignment is the first thing a recruiter's eye catches.
- Left-align all body text. Full justification creates uneven word spacing that reduces readability on screen.
- Use one bullet style throughout: round bullet or em-dash. Never arrows, checkmarks, or stars in the body.

### 1.3 Section Order

- Standard order: Contact Information → Professional Summary → Skills & Technical Expertise → Work Experience → Education → Certifications → Projects / Publications (if applicable).
- 0–2 years experience: Education may come before Work Experience. Beyond that, experience leads.
- Only include a section if you can fill it with quality content. A thin 'Awards' section with one entry from 2015 hurts more than it helps.
- Hobbies/Interests: include only if they are directly relevant (e.g., open-source contributor, published researcher, competitive coder on Codeforces).

### 1.4 ATS Compatibility

- ATS (Applicant Tracking System) scans your resume before any human sees it. Most companies above 50 employees use one. If the ATS can't parse you, no human ever reads you.
- Never put contact info, job titles, or skills inside headers, footers, or text boxes — ATS parsers skip them entirely.
- Avoid multi-column layouts unless you're certain of the application channel. Two-column resumes frequently parse out of order in ATS.
- Spell out acronyms on first use: 'Natural Language Processing (NLP)'. ATS matches strings — 'NLP' and 'Natural Language Processing' are different strings.

- Mirror keywords from the job description exactly: if the JD says 'stakeholder management', don't write 'stakeholder engagement' — ATS won't equate them.
- Use standard section labels: 'Work Experience', 'Education', 'Skills'. Creative headers like 'My Journey' or 'What I've Built' confuse parsers.
- No images, charts, tables (for skills), or graphical skill bars — all render as blank or garbled in ATS.

### 1.5 Contact Section

- Line 1: Full name in the largest font on the page (13–16 pt, bold). This is the one place size hierarchy is non-negotiable.
- Line 2: Phone | Professional Email | City, Country | LinkedIn URL | GitHub / Portfolio (if applicable).
- Email must be professional: firstname.lastname@gmail.com. Anything with nicknames, numbers, or old university handles damages credibility before the recruiter reads a single line.
- LinkedIn URL: customize it to linkedin.com/in/firstname-lastname. The default alphanumeric string looks unfinished.
- City and country only — no street address. Nobody mails you an offer letter.
- No date of birth, no marital status, no nationality, no photograph — unless you are applying in a region where this is legally required (e.g., certain MENA or European markets).

## PART 2 — PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

### 2.1 What It Is & Why It Matters

- The recruiter spends 6–10 seconds on first scan. The summary is the only section guaranteed to be read in that window — it decides whether the rest gets read at all.
- It is NOT an objective statement ('Seeking a challenging role where I can grow'). That phrasing is pre-2000s and signals no self-awareness.
- Think of it as a compressed pitch: who you are at your professional peak, the most valuable thing you have done, and the direction you are headed.
- Tailored to every role. A generic summary is the single biggest wasted opportunity on a resume. If your summary reads the same for 10 different jobs, it's working for none of them.
- Length: 3–4 lines, always. Two lines is too thin; five lines is an essay.

### 2.2 The Formula

**LINE 1 — Identity: [X years] + [role/title] + [domain/industry] + [2 defining strengths]**

LINE 2 — Proof: One concrete achievement with a number, scale, or named outcome. This is your hook.

LINE 3 — Direction: What problem you solve best + the kind of team/environment where you generate most value.

- Line 1 establishes your category. Recruiters think in buckets — make it instantly clear which bucket you belong in.
- Line 2 is your proof point. One strong metric beats five vague claims. If you have no metric yet, use scope: team size, user base, budget, geography.
- Line 3 is forward-facing. It tells the recruiter you have a perspective on your work — not just a job history.
- Strip every cliché: 'hardworking', 'team player', 'passionate', 'detail-oriented', 'results-driven'. These words appear on 90% of resumes and add zero signal.
- Read it aloud. If any sentence sounds like a brochure, rewrite it in plain human language.

## PART 3 — EDUCATION

### 3.1 Format

**Degree, Major | Institution Name** **Month Year**

GPA: X.X / 4.0 (include only if 3.5+ or distinction equivalent) | Honors / Scholarship (if notable)

- Degree and major first, institution second, graduation year right-aligned — always in this order.
- Include GPA only when it is a genuine strength: 3.5+/4.0, 8.5+/10, First Class, or Distinction. A middling GPA draws attention to a gap. Omit it; recruiters do not ask.
- Honors and scholarships: include when notable — 'Dean's List (4 semesters)', 'National Merit Scholar', 'Full Government Scholarship'. One-time, small-scale awards from 10 years ago: leave off.
- Relevant Coursework: use only for freshers or career changers bridging a technical gap. Maximum 5 courses. Format as a comma-separated inline list, not bullets.
- For experienced professionals (5+ years): education is 2–3 lines max. No coursework, no grade details. Your work speaks louder.
- Multiple degrees: most recent first. Omit high school once you have a college degree (unless you went to an institution where it carries signal, e.g., certain international prep schools).
- Bootcamps, MOOCs, and online credentials belong in Certifications, not Education — unless the bootcamp IS your primary qualification.

# PART 4 — CERTIFICATIONS & CREDENTIALS

## 4.1 Format & Rules

**Certification Name | Issuing Body | Year (add 'In Progress' if pending)**

- Only list industry-recognized credentials. A Udemy certificate is a course completion, not a certification. The distinction matters to technical recruiters.
- Maximum 4–5 certifications. If you have 12, list the 4 most recent and most role-relevant. A wall of certifications reads as credential-collecting, not expertise.
- Never list 'Microsoft Office Specialist' or 'Google Digital Garage' on a senior resume — they imply a skills floor, not a ceiling.
- Certifications in progress: include them — 'AWS Solutions Architect Associate (In Progress, Expected Jun 2025)' — they demonstrate direction and initiative.
- Expiry dates: include only in regulated fields (e.g., PMP renewal, security clearances, medical/legal credentials). Otherwise, the year of issue is sufficient.

# PART 5 — TAILORING, SUBMISSION & FINAL CHECKS

## 5.1 Tailoring for Every Application

- Read the job description twice. First pass: understand the role. Second pass: extract the top 6–8 required skills, tools, and outcomes.
- Mirror JD language in your summary, skills, and top 2–3 bullets. Not paraphrased — exact terms. ATS matches strings.
- Reorder your skills section so the most JD-relevant category appears first.
- Swap in 1–2 role-specific bullets you have prepared in a 'backup bullet bank' — a separate document where you keep 3–5 additional bullets per role that didn't fit the one-page constraint.
- Rewrite your summary for every application. This is 10 minutes of work. It is also the single highest-ROI activity in job searching.
- Time investment per application: 15–20 minutes of tailoring is the difference between a 2% and a 25% response rate.

## 5.2 The 10-Second Scan Test

- Open your resume. Set a 10-second timer. Look at it fresh. What registers immediately?
- Your name, current title, and most recent company should be instantly legible without searching.
- At least one metric (%, $, scale) should be visible in the first 3 bullets of work experience without zooming.
- If the page looks like a grey block of text — restructure. More white space, shorter bullets, bolder company names.
- Have one person who doesn't know your career history read it for 10 seconds and tell you what you do. If they can't, the summary and top section need rewriting.

## 5.3 Pre-Submission Checklist

- ✓ One page (or genuinely justified two pages for 8+ year profiles).
- ✓ No typos — spell-check and then manually read every line, top to bottom.
- ✓ Consistent tense: present for current role, past tense for all previous roles.
- ✓ Every bullet leads with an action verb. Zero instances of 'Responsible for' or 'Worked on'.
- ✓ Every bullet contains at least one quantifier or meaningful scope qualifier.
- ✓ Date format consistent throughout (e.g., 'Jan 2022' — not mixing 'January 2022' and '01/22').
- ✓ LinkedIn URL is customized and the profile is live and complete.
- ✓ PDF opens correctly and maintains formatting on both desktop and mobile.
- ✓ File named: FirstName_LastName_Resume.pdf.
- ✓ Top 6 keywords from the target JD appear naturally in the resume.

### 5.4 Universal Resume Mistakes

| ✗ Stop Doing This | ✓ Do This Instead |
|---|---|
| Objective statement: 'Seeking a challenging role where I can grow' | 3-line tailored summary: title + proof metric + direction |
| Skill bars, star ratings, or proficiency percentages | Grouped skill categories, clean comma-separated list |
| 'Responsible for managing...' / 'Worked on...' | Strong past-tense action verb + specific outcome |
| Duties listed without a single outcome or result | STAR-format bullets: action + scope + quantified result |
| No numbers anywhere — no %, $, time saved, or scale | Every role has at least one number: revenue, %, users, time |
| Identical resume sent to every job application | 15-minute tailored version per application, every time |
| Three-page resume with two years of experience | 1 tight, dense, high-signal page — 2 only if truly warranted |
| 'References available upon request' — wastes space | Remove it entirely — it occupies prime real estate |
| Soft skills section: 'Teamwork, Communication, Leadership' | Let the bullets prove soft skills — never claim them |
| Random bold text used for emphasis instead of scannability | Bold only: company names, job titles, key tech anchors |

## PART 6 — PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY (Sales Roles)

### 6.1 What Sales Hiring Managers Look for in a Summary

- Quota attainment, immediately: the first thing every sales hiring manager wants to know is whether you hit your number. Get this into the summary or the first bullet — not buried on page two.
- Deal profile: ACV (average contract value), sales cycle length, and deal complexity (SMB vs. mid-market vs. enterprise) must be clear. A $5K ACV SMB AE and a $200K ACV enterprise AE require completely different skills.
- Segment and motion: inbound vs. outbound, hunting vs. farming, transactional vs. consultative — these signal your fit for the specific role.
- Industry / vertical specialization: SaaS, fintech, HR tech, cybersecurity, healthcare — domain knowledge shortens ramp time and is a hiring differentiator.
- Sales methodology: MEDDIC, MEDDPICC, Challenger, SPIN, Command of the Message — name the methodologies you have been trained in and actively use. Serious sales organizations hire to methodology.

### 6.2 Summary Formula — Account Executive (AE)

> [X-year] Account Executive with a track record of [consistent / President's Club] quota attainment in [SMB / mid-market / enterprise] [sector: SaaS / fintech / HR tech] sales.
>
> Consistently achieved [X% of quota / top X% of team] selling [ACV range: $X–$Y] contracts with [sales cycle length] cycles.
>
> Experienced in [methodology: MEDDIC / Challenger / SPICED] and skilled at [motion: full-cycle outbound / inbound / expansion / territory] sales for [buyer: CTO / CFO / CHRO / VP-level] stakeholders.

### 6.3 Summary Formula — SDR / BDR

> [X-year] SDR / BDR consistently ranked in the top X% of [company name / cohort] for meetings booked and pipeline generated in the [sector] space.

Generated $XM in qualified pipeline [per quarter / annually] through [outbound motion: cold calling, LinkedIn sequencing, multi-channel] targeting [ICP: VP Engineering / CFO / Head of HR] at [company size] companies.

Trained in [methodology: MEDDIC / SPIN / Challenger] and [tool stack: Salesforce, Outreach, LinkedIn Sales Navigator, ZoomInfo]. Looking to move into [AE / closing] in [sector / product area].

## 6.4 Summary Formula — Sales Manager / Director

[X-year] Sales [Manager / Director / VP] with a record of building and scaling [SMB / enterprise / commercial] sales teams in [sector] SaaS.

Grew team from [X] to [Y] reps while increasing team quota attainment from [X%] to [Y%] and [reducing ramp time / improving win rate / growing ACV by Z%].

Expert in [GTM strategy: territory design, comp design, pipeline forecasting] and [methodology: MEDDIC / Challenger]. Experience with [PLG / outbound-led / partner-led] growth motions.

## 6.5 Worked Examples

### SDR — Outbound, 1 year

SDR ranked 2nd of 14 in my cohort for pipeline generated ($2.1M in Q4 FY24) at a Series B HR tech company. Averaged 22 meetings booked per month against a 15-meeting quota through a structured 8-touch outbound sequence (cold call → LinkedIn → personalized email) targeting VP HR and CHROs at 200–2,000 employee companies. Trained in MEDDIC and Command of the Message. Targeting AE roles in the HCM or L&D SaaS space.

### Mid-Market AE — SaaS (3–5 years)

Account Executive with 4 years of full-cycle SaaS sales in the cybersecurity sector, consistently achieving 118% of quota and twice recognized as a President's Club qualifier. Closed $3.2M in new ARR in FY24 with an average deal size of $62K and a 74-day average sales cycle, selling to CISOs and VP Infrastructure at 500–5,000 employee enterprises. Expert in MEDDPICC and a Challenger-trained seller.

### Enterprise AE (5+ years)

Enterprise Account Executive with 6 years closing complex, multi-stakeholder deals in the fintech and payments infrastructure space. Closed $1.8M–$2.4M ARR annually, including the company's largest-ever deal ($780K ACV, 14-month cycle) with a Tier 1 bank involving legal, compliance, and C-suite sign-off. Adept at navigating 10+ stakeholder buying committees using MEDDIC and managing 18–24 month territory plans.

### Sales Manager (4+ years managing)

Sales Manager with 5 years building and leading mid-market SaaS sales teams. Grew a 6-person team to 14 reps while improving average quota attainment from 74% to 103% over 8 quarters. Reduced average ramp time for new AEs from 5.5 months to 3.2 months through a structured 90-day onboarding curriculum and bi-weekly deal coaching sessions using MEDDIC.

# PART 7 — SKILLS & EXPERTISE (Sales)

## 7.1 How to Structure the Sales Skills Section

- Sales resumes are the one case where the skills section is lighter than in technical roles — but it must still be structured. Recruiters scan for CRM fluency, methodology, and market knowledge.
- The work experience section carries 80% of the weight on a sales resume. The skills section supports it — it doesn't replace it.
- Never list generic skills like 'cold calling', 'prospecting', 'relationship building', 'communication'. These are minimum expectations for anyone applying to a sales role, not differentiators.

## 7.2 Category Guide for Sales

CRM & Sales Tools: Salesforce (SFDC), HubSpot, Outreach, Salesloft, Gong, Chorus, LinkedIn Sales Navigator, ZoomInfo, Lusha, Seamless.ai

Sales Methodologies: MEDDIC, MEDDPICC, Challenger Sale, SPIN Selling, Command of the Message, BANT, SPICED

Pipeline & Forecasting: Salesforce Opportunity Management, Pipeline Reviews, Commit / Best Case / Upside Forecasting

Market Knowledge: [Your vertical: FinTech / HR Tech / Cybersecurity / DevTools / MarTech / HealthTech]

Buyer Profiles: CXO, VP Engineering, CFO, CHRO, Head of Security (list your actual ICP stakeholders)

Sales Motion: Full-cycle Outbound / Inbound / PLG-led / Partner-sourced / Land-and-Expand

- Gong or Chorus proficiency: mention it if you've used it for call coaching. It signals that you take performance improvement seriously.
- For sales leadership: add 'Team Development: Hiring, Onboarding, Quota Setting, Territory Design, Compensation Planning'.
- For SDRs: emphasize sequencing tools (Outreach, Salesloft), prospecting tools (ZoomInfo, Lusha, Apollo), and LinkedIn Sales Navigator — these are the core of the SDR toolkit.

## PART 8 — WORK EXPERIENCE (Sales)

### 8.1 Role Header Format

**Account Executive, Mid-Market | Company Name (Series C B2B SaaS, $45M ARR) Jan 2022 – Present**

City, Country (or 'Remote') | Territory: [if applicable — APAC / UK&I / North America West]

- Adding territory context matters for enterprise and field sales roles — it signals scope.
- Add segment context in the title or the first line: 'Account Executive, Mid-Market' tells the recruiter more than 'Account Executive' alone.

### 8.2 The Sales Bullet Framework

**STRUCTURE: [Action Verb] + [What sales motion / deal type] + [Quota or target context] + [Outcome: attainment %, ARR, deals, ranking]**

EXAMPLE (AE): Closed $2.8M in new ARR in FY24 (116% of $2.4M quota), including 3 deals above $200K ACV — the most $200K+ deals closed by any AE in the mid-market segment that year.

EXAMPLE (SDR): Generated $3.4M in qualified pipeline in Q3 FY24 through a structured 9-touch cold outbound sequence, booking 27 meetings against a 15-meeting quota (180% attainment) — ranked 1st of 11 SDRs that quarter.

### 8.3 The Core Sales Metrics — Every Role, Every Bullet

- QUOTA ATTAINMENT: The single most important number on a sales resume. State it as a percentage and an absolute: '118% of $1.8M quota' not just '$2.1M'. Both matter — percentages show performance; absolutes show deal scale.
- RANKING: 'Top 10% of the sales team', '2nd of 18 AEs', 'President's Club (3 consecutive years)'. Relative ranking contextualizes your quota attainment. A 110% attainment at a company where 90% of reps hit 110% is different from a 110% attainment where the average is 70%.
- PIPELINE GENERATED: For outbound-heavy roles: total pipeline sourced ($M), meetings booked (vs. quota), and conversion rate from meeting to opportunity. Pipeline gen is the leading indicator; quota attainment is the lagging one.
- DEAL METRICS: Average contract value (ACV), average sales cycle (days), largest single deal closed ($). These three numbers paint the full picture of deal complexity and selling skill.
- EFFICIENCY: Win rate (%), proposal-to-close ratio, or multi-year deal conversion — signals quality of deal qualification and closing skill, not just volume.
- EXPANSION: NRR on existing accounts, upsell/cross-sell ARR generated, logo retention rate — critical for account management and land-and-expand motion roles.

### 8.4 Strong Action Verb Bank (Sales)

AE/IC: Closed • Sourced • Negotiated • Prospected • Identified • Qualified • Expanded • Renewed • Developed • Built • Navigated • Drove • Exceeded • Achieved • Landed • Converted • Recovered

SDR: Generated • Booked • Prospected • Researched • Sequenced • Outreached • Qualified • Converted • Built • Created • Engaged • Identified • Delivered • Surpassed

Manager: Built • Scaled • Coached • Hired • Ramped • Developed • Designed • Drove • Led • Grew • Restructured • Reduced • Improved • Increased • Launched

## 8.5 Before vs. After — Sales Bullets

| ✗ Vague (Never Write These) | ✓ Specific (Write These Instead) |
|---|---|
| Responsible for managing a sales territory | Managed a 120-account territory across APAC mid-market (500–3,000 employees), closing $2.1M in new ARR — 109% of $1.92M annual quota |
| Worked to exceed monthly quotas | Achieved 122% quota attainment in FY24 ($2.44M vs. $2M target), ranking 3rd of 21 AEs in the commercial segment — first consecutive year above 120% |
| Generated leads through cold calling | Generated 31 qualified opportunities per month through a 7-touch cold outbound sequence (cold call + video voicemail + LinkedIn InMail), sourcing $1.6M in pipeline against a $900K monthly target |
| Built relationships with enterprise clients | Closed a $520K ACV 3-year deal with a Tier 2 bank after an 11-month sales cycle involving 6 C-level stakeholders across IT, Risk, and Finance — the second-largest new-logo deal in company history |
| Supported the team with account management | Grew 6 enterprise accounts from a combined $480K ARR to $1.1M ARR over 18 months through structured expansion plays, multi-product adoption, and executive sponsor programs |
| Helped close deals and grow revenue | Sourced $3.8M in new pipeline in Q2 through partner co-selling with 4 AWS and Salesforce partners, contributing 35% of the team's total Q2 pipeline — a new channel with zero prior investment |
| Managed a book of business | Managed a $4.2M ARR book of 22 mid-market accounts, achieving 107% NRR in FY24 by identifying and closing $390K in upsell ARR within existing customer base |
| Drove revenue growth for the company | Exceeded revenue targets in 7 of 8 quarters, growing territory ARR from $800K to $2.3M through a combination of new logo acquisition and disciplined account expansion |

## 8.6 Sales Manager / Leadership Bullets

- The key shift from IC to manager bullets: you are measured on team performance, not personal quota. Your bullets should show aggregate team outcomes, not what you sold personally.

> Built the mid-market AE team from 4 to 11 reps over 6 quarters; team collectively closed $14.2M in new ARR in FY24, achieving 106% of team quota — first year team exceeded 100% in 3 years.
>
> Reduced new AE ramp time from 5 months to 2.8 months by designing a 90-day competency-based onboarding programme with weekly role-play assessments, pipeline milestones, and Gong call reviews.
>
> Implemented MEDDPICC qualification across the 8-person enterprise team, increasing average deal size from $68K to $112K ACV and win rate from 18% to 29% over 4 quarters.

# PART 9 — AWARDS, RECOGNITION & CERTIFICATIONS (Sales)

## 9.1 Awards & Recognition — How to Include Them

- President's Club / Achievers Club: the most powerful sales credential. Include year, company, and what it took to qualify: 'President's Club, FY22 & FY23 (qualified by achieving 120%+ quota for 2 consecutive years)'.
- Quarterly performance recognitions: include if top-ranking — 'Q3 FY24 Top SDR (1st of 14, pipeline generated)'. Do not include generic 'Team Player of the Month' — it signals you had nothing more substantive to list.
- Company-specific rankings: '1st in cohort of 22 AEs for new logo ARR', 'Rookie of the Year, FY23' — concrete rankings are always more powerful than vague awards.

- Create a standalone 'Awards & Recognition' section if you have 2+ substantive recognitions. Otherwise, embed them as a final bullet in the relevant role.

## 9.2 Certifications for Sales Professionals

- Salesforce Certified Administrator / Salesforce Certified Sales Cloud Consultant — strong for sales ops and enterprise AE roles where deep SFDC usage is expected.
- MEDDIC / MEDDPICC Certification (Winning by Design, Force Management) — not widely certified but the training names are recognizable. If you went through Command of the Message training, name it.
- Challenger Sale Certification (Challenger Inc.) — signals methodological depth, especially for complex enterprise deals.
- HubSpot Sales Software Certification / HubSpot Inbound Sales — relevant for SMB and startup AE roles using HubSpot CRM.
- LinkedIn Sales Navigator Certification — a minor signal but worth including at SDR/BDR level when the tool list is otherwise thin.
- Sandler Sales Training (Sandler Certified) — recognized in many mid-market and enterprise selling environments.